

*Baby terrapins call to each other through
their eggshells before hatching!*

Terrapin

Imagine wearing a suit of armour that you could never take off! Turtles spend their whole life in the same smooth, snug shell, which keeps getting bigger as they grow. Their backbone and ribs have even become part of the sturdy shield. In some Native American myths, the whole world is held up on the back of a giant cosmic turtle.

Freshwater turtles are sometimes called terrapins. They are equally happy in water or on land, and love sunbathing to warm up. The false map turtle is a freshwater turtle named after the wiggly lines on its shell. These lines look a bit like the looping curves that show height on maps.

